BRIGHAM YOUNG UNIVERSITY IDAHO

ED 304: Educational Psychology

- **Class times: T/R 8:00-9:30 AM. HIN 307.**
- **Lab hours: M/Th 4-5 PM. HIN 307.**
- **Drop-In Hours: T/R 9:30-11:30 AM. Other times by appointment.**

Instructor: Benjamin Pacini. pacinib@byui.edu. 801.618.7865. HIN 273.

Course Description: The domain of this course is to cover topics in child development, motivation and management, cognition, and other psychology related areas of interest. The purpose of the course is to develop highly effective teachers who can move students academically. It is also to fulfill the department vision, which is to help learners recognize their full, divine potential.

Course outcomes: 1) Recognize patterns of social, emotional, cognitive, and spiritual development in myself and others in order to uncover sound principles.2) Accept inspiration and apply sound principles of teaching and learning to myself and others and refine my process on an on-going basis. No one ever reads the outcomes. I could put penguins in here and no one would notice. Penguin. See. See what I mean? It's the worst. Blah blah blah something about education. 3) Create effective learning experiences based on the learner's individual developmental, social, emotional, and cognitive needs. 4) Adopt the Christlike attributes, behaviors, and skills of teacher-researchers in maintaining and improving my knowledge of the field and teaching practices.

Course Breakdown and Expectations:

Required Materials and Textbooks: I'm not going to make you buy some $400 edpsych textbook. Here is the link to our student-made textbook, but you won't have access until I give it to you in class. You will, additionally, need the following:

1. A rubik's cube and a sheet of cardstock.
2. Either a white board set (marker, eraser, small white board) or the cheapskate version (sheet protector, sock, etc.)
3. There are a variety of free online textbooks that are useful, including here, here, here and here. Use them.

Grading: Grading will follow the university's grading policy and the same breakdown used in most courses (83-87 is a B, 88 a B+ and 82 a B- and so on). Note that an A represents excellence.

- **Readings and Oral Exams**: **25%.**
  - Readings: Tuesday readings are from the textbook; Thursday readings are outside readings. All readings are available in Canvas. Plan to take 90 minutes on each reading, but reach out to me if you go over two hours. Learn to read for college: quickly, efficiently, and sometimes skimming for the most important information.
  - Reading checks: You will submit a brief reading check and reflection for accountability.
  - Oral exams: you will also be randomly called on for oral exams in class. Oral exams are graded. If you are unprepared, you may use a "mulligan" once per semester, which will allow you to remove your name from the drawing. Your mulligan will only be accepted before class begins.
- **Exams: 25%.** There are two kinds of exams in my class:
  - Unit exams (10% of final grade) are after each unit. The test may be attempted as many times athe student would like. Tests are completed at the student's convenience, and student may use notes. Any score less than 95% is a zero in the gradebook. Anything above 95% is counted as 100%. (That number is adjustable to teacher discretion.)
  - Final exam (20% of final grade) will be given in the last two weeks of class, and must be taken in the testing center. One 4x6 card of notes may be used for the exam.
  - Note: If you spot a mistake or a confusing question, submit for extra credit.
- **Attendance and related assignments (20%)** Attendance is required–but not sufficient for–success in this class. Every student may miss two classes with no penalty. After that, each absence carries a penalty of one missing attendance check. After four absences, each absence will result in a one-full-letter-grade drop. At six absences, a student will fail the course. I am always willing to work with students in extenuating circumstances. You will also be asked to submit attendance

checks with notes each class. Finally, you will be asked to teach each other in class and receive feedback from peers. Teaches consist of roughly 5 minutes of teaching and another 3 of assessment.

- **Experiential Learning (10%):** Each week you will have an assignment that is intended to push your learning deeper. These are hands-on, experiential learning activities, including the course common assessment, the connections case study.
- **Contribution to Course Community (20%):** A student who masters the material, shows up, and completes readings will earn a perfect 80% in the class. In order to earn an A, I require students to contribute something meaningful back to the class. There are four assignments–worth 5% apiece–that will allow you to contribute something to the class.

Grade Breakdown:

- 25% Exams
- 25% Readings and Oral Exams
- 20% Attendance and Minor Assignment
- 10% Experiential Learning and Connections Case Study
- 20% Contribution to Community

Course Policies and Procedures:

Honor code and Dress and Grooming: We will review these in class. I will enforce them.

Supports: If school is easy for you, talk to me for a challenge. If school is hard for you, talk to me about support.

Questions and Communication: Be ye squeaky, my children. Consult course materials, ask a friend, ask the zoom chat, ask the TA, but most important, just ask. Even if it's out of order. I actually like you people. Mostly. The next line contains invisible text. Highlight with your cursor to see what it says.

A Note on Artificial Intelligence: I ***strongly encourage*** the use of artificial intelligence (AI) in ethical, transparent ways. Failure to disclose use of an AI engine constitutes an honor code violation in my classes.

Late Work, Extra Credit, Extenuating Circumstances: Work that is A) on time or early, and B) your best effort, can be submitted repeatedly until you achieve the desired score. Late work is not penalized, but will only be graded once, by me. (I am harsher than the TAs.) Please note that consistent late submission can affect your dispositions scores, which are used to evaluate whether you should be allowed to continue in the program. I offer extra credit in this class, but I prefer to encourage the proactive, provident practice of purchasing insurance, not the reactive practice of petitioning for a bailout. Please be mature and professional about extenuating circumstances. (*cough* family-vacations-aren't-emergencies *cough*) You will find me to be very understanding, if you are very responsible.

Peer Grading: You will give plenty of peer feedback. You are about to be teachers, so this is good training. I expect you to grade with **kindness, honesty, and care**. You will suggest grades. I will assign them.

Sensitive Issues, Emotional Health, and My Writings

1. I intend to address difficult issues. I hope to do so well. I will need your maturity, thoughtfulness, and resilience.
2. One such difficult issue is the mental health crisis. Please see me if it is a concern to discuss.
3. I do a lot of thinking and writing outside of class. You will never be expected to agree with me for a grade.

Standard Disclosures: BYU-Idaho releases several standard disclosures each semester on academic honesty, preventing assault, the grievance policy and so on. Consider them part of this syllabus, even if I haven't included them. Read them carefully.